

Exploring the ChatGPT Era: Finding Equilibrium Between Innovation and Tradition in Education

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Abstract

The study explores the optimal integration of the AI-powered chatbot ChatGPT into educational practices. It evaluates the balance between adopting innovative technologies and preserving traditional teaching methodologies to enhance learning outcomes while addressing concerns about diminished human interaction and spreading misinformation. Utilizing qualitative research methods, the study includes semi-structured interviews with 30 educators, students, administrators, and other stakeholders and focus group discussions with 20 participants to encourage collaborative interpretation. Thematic analysis is conducted to identify recurring themes and patterns in the qualitative data. The findings reveal that while ChatGPT offers significant potential for personalized and interactive education, it also presents challenges such as understanding context and potential biases. Educators recognize the advantages of ChatGPT for generating writing prompts, assisting with storytelling, and improving vocabulary. However, there are concerns about over-reliance on technology and the risk of misinformation. The study provides practical insights for educators and policymakers on responsibly integrating ChatGPT into educational settings. Recommendations include implementing robust assessment methods, using plagiarism detection software, conducting viva voce sessions, and educating students on the ethical use of AI. Moreover, the study emphasizes the importance of maintaining academic integrity and fostering a culture of honesty. It highlights the need for continuous professional development for educators to effectively utilize AI tools and stay updated with technological advancements, underlining the evolving nature of education and the role of AI. By expanding the understanding of ChatGPT's role in education, the research underscores the necessity of balancing AI innovation with traditional pedagogical principles. It provides strategies for leveraging the benefits of AI while upholding the core values of education, ensuring responsible technology use, and promoting an ethical framework in educational environments. This approach aims to enhance learning experiences without compromising the essential human elements of teaching and learning.